Daniel Cordoba Paez

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Co-founder and CTO building space domain awareness and satellite autonomy software. Primary author of ATLAS, now flying on a pilot mission; previously drove $1B+ in annualized incremental revenue through experiments at Amazon.

Experience

Co-founder and CTO, Stellerian – Seattle, WA June 2022 – Present

Defense-tech space startup; Techstars Space ’25, CDL Space 2026; $800K pre-seed, $160MM in LOIs.

- Led ATLAS, our space domain awareness software, through integration and mission acceptance for its on-orbit pilot with Satlyt as technical scoping lead, primary author, ICD author, and integration point of contact.
- Technical lead on a $1.8MM, 24-month SpaceWERX D2P2 for deorbit as a service, executing most of the work.
- Architected and built over 90% of the codebase across ATLAS, ARGUS, and ACECam, taking each from prototype to production; now hiring hardware and GNC engineers (Jan 2027) to take ownership.
- Owned pose estimation for a Phase I AFRL STTR with one supporting engineer: generated the datasets, trained and tuned the model, and integrated it on Jetson for preliminary HITL feasibility; published at AIAA SciTech 2026.
- Optimized ARGUS for flight compute, cutting Jetson AGX Orin inference from 1.2 s to 100 ms (TensorRT FP16, retrained heads, smaller backbone) to meet a 5 Hz budget.
- Wrote a distributed Blender renderer for any spacecraft with realistic lighting and sensors: 100K+ labeled images.
- Stood up self-hosted AI tooling to keep CUI, ITAR data, and IP in our AWS account: Claude on Bedrock, SSO-gated OpenWebUI, and a shared Claude Code skill library the team contributes to and uses to write proposals.
- Directing technical scoping for a Blackwing follow-on mission and our prime team in the BMC3I TAP Lab.

Software Engineer II, Amazon – Seattle, WA May 2025 – September 2026

- Drove $1B+ in annualized incremental revenue across “Keep Shopping For” ($1B+/month in attributed revenue).
- Led hybridization of relevant ads into organic recommendations across 5 surfaces and 3 teams: managed 5 experiments, guided two engineers, and delivered 25%+ of a 5-team clickshare goal.
- Shipped a cross-team launch that added a new behavioral signal to every “Keep Shopping For” feature, working around A/B-testing constraints to generate $225MM in annualized incremental revenue.
- Supervised an intern-led migration of the impression ranking processor, reducing P99 latency from 35ms to 10ms.

Software Engineer I, Amazon – Seattle, WA February 2024 – April 2025

- Ran homepage recommendation experiments worth $400MM in annualized impact, making the feature #2 on Amazon’s mobile homepage by click-through rate and attributed revenue.

Software Engineer (Consulting), Factory Wheel Warehouse – Remote January 2022 – February 2024

- Automated order importing, PO reconciliation, and tracking for 350+ monthly orders ($1MM+/yr, 70% of sales), reducing manual work 60%; added ship-by-date alerts that cut late shipments 80%.

Software Engineer Intern, Amazon – Seattle, WA Summer–Fall 2022, Summer 2023

- Built alarm-driven deployment aborts for Amazon’s company-wide CI/CD (200+ deployments per minute).
- Extended “Keep Shopping For” (12M+ daily users) to desktop with server-side device detection in Java/Spring.

Publications

S. G. Jo, C. Waldecker, L. E. Mendoza Zambrano, R. Schmitt, J. Schmitt, **D. Cordoba Paez**, and D. Canales, “Optimal Computer Vision-Based Spacecraft Rendezvous and Proximity Operations in the Cislunar Region,” AIAA SciTech 2026 Forum, Orlando, FL, January 2026. doi:10.2514/6.2026-2200

Education

Western Governors University – B.S. in Computer Science July 2020 – December 2023

Skills

Languages: Python, Java, TypeScript, C++

Space & Embedded: NASA F´, NVIDIA Jetson AGX Orin, HITL integration

ML/CV: PyTorch, ONNX, TensorRT, Blender

Backend & Cloud: FastAPI, Spring, Spark, Docker, AWS (CDK, Lambda, DynamoDB, EventBridge, S3, EMR)